MĪZĀN FORMATION INSTITUTE

The Mīzān Curriculum Platform

A Product Brief for Engineering & UX

Prepared for the build team · Cairo · 2026

ENGLISH EDITION

THE IDEA, IN ONE PARAGRAPH

§1 What we are building

A web platform that hosts a K–12 character-formation curriculum and lets a teacher teach it straight from the screen. The student-facing slides project onto the classroom board; at the same time the teacher sees a private script, notes, and timing on their own laptop or tablet. Behind that single interaction sits a searchable library of roughly 260 lessons across the Mīzān, Arête, and Iḥsān tracks — each lesson a structured object of prep, slides, script, and materials that the teacher can lightly adapt without breaking the master version.

This document is the gist for a programmer and a UX designer: what the thing is, how a teacher moves through it, the shape of a lesson, what we are deliberately copying from the Second Step SEL platform, what our context needs that theirs does not, and where I would draw the line for a first build. The last page is a list of open questions I need the build team to answer back.

Who uses it

- **Teachers (primary).** Open a lesson, read the prep, teach from the two-surface view, and lightly adapt the copy in front of them.
- **Curriculum authors (the Mīzān team).** Create and maintain the canonical master lessons — text, slides, script, order, media. This is the source of truth.
- **School admins (later).** Manage teachers and see what is being taught and how far along a class is.
- **Students do <u>not</u> log in for the first version.** Lessons are teacher-led and projected. This is a scoping decision, not an oversight — it removes a whole layer of accounts, privacy, and moderation from v1. **[Likely worth holding to]**

§2 The core interaction — two surfaces

This is the heart of the product; everything else supports it. One lesson is shown through **two synchronised views at once.**

> ### Board view — what students see
>
> Clean slides, large type, the image or prompt or question the class is looking at. Nothing else on screen. This is what goes on the projector or smart-board.

> ### Teacher view — what only the teacher sees
>
> The same slide shown small, plus the **script for that exact slide**, the teaching notes, the suggested timing, and a preview of the next slide. The advance controls live here. The teacher reads this while the class watches the board.

Splitting each slide into a public face and a private script is the single design decision the whole platform turns on. It is also why lessons must be stored as **structured data** — separate fields for board content and script — rather than as flat PowerPoint or PDF files where the two are fused.

Two ways to deliver this — the team picks

- **A · Dual display.** The teacher's laptop drives the projector as a second screen: board view full-screen on the projector, teacher view on the laptop. Uses the browser's full-screen / Presentation API. Simplest to build.
- **B · Companion device.** A classroom PC projects the board view; the teacher holds a phone or tablet showing the script and advancing the slides, synced live over a WebSocket. Better for rooms where the teacher is not tethered to the projector cable.

Recommendation [Likely]: ship **A** first because it is far cheaper, then add **B** as a fast-follow once teachers are actually using it and tell us they need to move around the room.

§3 Anatomy of a lesson

Every lesson in the library is the same shape. This is effectively the data model.

- **Header.** Title, grade, track (Mīzān / Arête / Iḥsān), unit or strand, estimated time, learning objective(s), and alignment tags.
- **Prepare — the "prime."** A short read-before-you-teach brief: what this lesson is really doing, what to watch for, and the one thing not to miss. Ours leans harder on this than most platforms, because the whole thesis is that *formation depends on the teacher's own readiness,* not just the content.
- **Slides.** Five to fifteen-plus student-facing slides, depending on the lesson. Each slide is its own object: board content + its own script + notes + suggested timing.
- **Materials.** Downloadable handouts, printables, and any media the lesson uses.
- **Close.** A reflection prompt or exit question — the formation beat, not just a content recap. Light in the first version.

§4 Navigation & the library

Modelled on Second Step's structure, which teachers already find legible.

- **Home / dashboard** → pick a program track and a grade.
- **Scope & sequence:** Track → Grade → Unit → Lesson, laid out so a teacher or school can see the whole year at a glance.
- **Lesson list** with search and filters — by grade, track, theme or virtue, and objective.
- **Lesson page** (prepare, slides, materials). A single "Teach" button launches the two-surface view.

- **Pacing view** so a class's progress through the sequence is visible at a glance.

§5 Editing & authoring — fidelity with flexibility

Two tiers, kept strictly apart.

- **Authoring (Mīzān team).** Create and edit the canonical master lessons — text, slides, script, order, media. The source of truth every teacher pulls from.
- **Teacher adaptation.** A teacher can adjust the copy in front of them — edit slide text, reword or add to the script, reorder, hide a slide, or add a slide — but always as a **personal override** ("My version") that never touches the master lesson or another teacher's copy. Copy-on-edit; reset-to-original always one click away.

For a formation curriculum this separation matters: we want teachers to make a lesson their own without eroding the designed sequence that makes it work.

§6 Getting slides in — Canva & Google Slides

You asked specifically about pulling slides in from Canva or Google Slides. There are three routes, with a real trade-off between them.

- **Option A — Import as images / PDF (recommended for v1).** Export the Canva or Google Slides deck to PDF or PNG; the platform ingests each slide as the board image and attaches the script fields alongside it. Simple, reliable, and offline-friendly. Trade-off: slides are not editable inside the platform — to change one, you re-import.
- **Option B — Embed / link live.** Paste a Google Slides "publish to web" link and the platform embeds it as the board view. No conversion, and it stays in sync with the source. Trade-off: needs live internet, gives us less control over layout, makes clean per-slide scripting harder, and leans on Google's embed staying available.

- **Option C — Native slide builder.** Build slides inside the platform with text, image, and layout blocks — full control, fully wired into the script and the two-surface view, works offline. Trade-off: this is essentially a small PowerPoint and the most expensive thing on the list to build well.

Recommendation [Likely]: ship **A** now, offer **B** as a convenience for teachers who live in Google Slides, and build a light version of **C** later once the rest is proven.

§7 What we copy from Second Step

We take the **shape and the user experience,** not the content — ours is Mīzān's formation curriculum. Worth copying:

- Ready-to-teach, low-prep lessons with the teacher **script built into each lesson.**
- The Grade → Unit → Lesson structure with a clear scope & sequence.
- Each lesson as three linked pieces: a teacher lesson plan (the script), a presentation deck, and downloadable student handouts.
- Built-in teacher onboarding and "quick-start" training, so a teacher can begin without a manual.
- A leadership / admin dashboard for a school to track progress.
- A bank of supplemental resources — extra activities and media a teacher can reach for.

§8 What their model lacks that ours needs

Second Step is built for US schools. Our context adds requirements they never had to meet.

- **Bilingual interface, full right-to-left.** The platform itself — not only the lesson content — must work in Arabic and English, in both text directions. This is a first-class requirement that shapes the whole front-end from day one, not a translation added at the end.
- **Low-bandwidth / offline mode.** Cairo classrooms have uneven internet. A teacher should be able to download a lesson, or a whole unit, and teach it

fully offline, then sync later. This pushes us toward the import-as-images route and a downloadable lesson pack.

- **A stronger teacher prep register.** The "prime" carries more weight for us, because our thesis is formation over information.
- **Reflection / formation capture** at a lesson's close — light in v1, but designed in.
- **Roles built for our distribution:** super-admin, school admin, teacher — and, later, a **certified-trainer** role tied to a train-the-trainer path.

§9 Suggested build phases

Phase 0 — Validate without building (weeks, near-zero cost)

Run one live cohort using Google Slides plus a shared script document, in person or over a call. Confirm two things before a line of platform code is written: that teachers actually teach *from the script,* and that the two-surface idea earns its keep.

> *A bespoke platform is the most expensive and slowest way to find out whether teachers will use these lessons. The build should follow evidence of demand, not run ahead of it. Phase 0 exists so the Phase 1 quote is spent on something already known to work.*

Phase 1 — MVP (this is what to quote)

- Lesson library with Track / Grade / Unit / Lesson navigation.
- Lesson page: prepare, slides, materials.
- The two-surface Teach view — dual-display (Option A).
- Import-as-images slide ingestion (Option A).
- Basic teacher adaptation: edit, hide, reorder, add — on a personal copy.
- Teacher login.
- Bilingual, right-to-left interface from the start.

Phase 2

Native light slide editor; Google Slides embed option; companion-device presenter mode; teacher onboarding / training modules; printable-handout system; admin dashboard; downloadable offline packs.

Phase 3

Reflection capture; usage analytics; multi-school management; certified-trainer role; possible LMS integrations.

> *Scope the quote to Phase 1. Everything past it is a roadmap for pricing conversations, not a requirement for the first build.*

§10 Open questions for you

A good brief ends with what it does not yet know. I need the build team to answer back on:

- ? Two-surface delivery: dual-display first, or is the companion phone/tablet essential for our classrooms sooner than I think?
- ? Slide-in strategy: is importing images enough for v1, or does in-platform editing need to arrive earlier?
- ? How hard is the offline requirement — a nice-to-have, or a dealbreaker for Cairo rooms?
- ? Should a teacher's edits fork (a full copy) or overlay the master? (My lean: copy-on-edit.)
- ? Will students ever log in, or is teacher-projected the permanent model?
- ? Who authors the ~260 lessons, in what tool, and what ingestion format do you want them delivered in?
- ? Expected scale in year one — how many schools, teachers, and concurrent classes?
- ? Hosting, data residency, and privacy expectations. (Student data stays minimal by design if there are no student logins.)